

Feedback vs Rejection

Understand the difference between change requests and rejections

Overview

Understanding the difference between feedback (change requests) and rejection helps you know how to respond and what to expect. Both are part of the review process but have different implications for your workflow and how you proceed. Change requests allow improvement and resubmission, while rejection is a final decision requiring a new item. Understanding this distinction helps you respond appropriately and move forward effectively.

Possible Outcomes

When reviewers provide input, there are two types: **Change Requests (Feedback)** - less severe, reviewers want modifications but the item can be improved and resubmitted, and **Rejection** - more severe, reviewers have decided the item cannot proceed, and you must create a new item to try again. Understanding these outcomes helps you know what to expect and how to respond.

What Each Outcome Means

Change Requests (Feedback) are requests for modifications to improve the item. Issues can be fixed through editing, it's an iterative improvement process, it's not a final state—the item can proceed after changes, and it's an opportunity to refine and improve. When changes are requested, status changes to show changes are requested (e.g., "CHANGES_REQUESTED"), the item becomes editable again, you can make modifications, you can save multiple times while working, and you can resubmit when changes are complete. The outcome is that the item can be improved and resubmitted, the process can continue after changes, iterative improvement is possible, multiple rounds of changes are allowed, and the item can eventually be approved. Change requests enable refinement and improvement rather than requiring starting over.

Rejection is a final decision that the item will not proceed. The item cannot be fixed through editing, it's a final state—the process stops here, you must create a new item to try again, and it's more severe than change requests. When an item is rejected, status changes to "Rejected" or "REJECTED," the item becomes read-only, it cannot be edited, it cannot be resubmitted, and the process stops for this item. The outcome is that the item cannot proceed, you must create a new item to try again, the rejected item remains as a record, and you can learn from rejection feedback for future submissions. Rejection requires starting fresh with a new item.

Key Differences - Change requests allow editing and resubmission, while rejection does not. Change requests enable iterative improvement, while rejection requires starting over. Change requests are less severe and indicate potential for approval, while rejection is final and indicates the item cannot proceed. Understanding these differences helps you know how to respond.

Next Steps for Users

When Changes Are Requested - Read the change request carefully to understand what specific modifications are needed. Make all requested changes thoroughly and address all requested items. Review your changes before resubmitting to ensure everything is complete. Resubmit when changes are complete—the item will go back to review status. Be prepared for multiple rounds of changes if needed, as iterative improvement is part of the process. Use change requests as opportunities to refine and improve your submissions.

When an Item Is Rejected - Review the rejection reason carefully to understand why the item was rejected. Learn from rejection feedback to improve future submissions. Create a completely new item that addresses the issues identified in the rejection. Ensure the new item complies with all requirements and has all necessary information. Try again with improvements, incorporating lessons learned from the rejection. Use rejection feedback to understand requirements better and improve your approach.

Understanding the Difference - Change requests mean the reviewer sees potential but needs improvements—you can fix and resubmit. Rejection means the reviewer has decided the item cannot proceed—you must start fresh with a new item. Change requests allow iterative improvement, while rejection requires starting over. Both provide valuable feedback, but they require different responses. Understanding this distinction helps you respond appropriately and move forward effectively.

Responding Appropriately - When changes are requested, focus on making improvements and resubmitting. When items are rejected, focus on learning from feedback and creating better new items. Both outcomes provide valuable feedback that helps you improve. Use feedback to refine your approach and create better submissions. Understanding how to respond helps you work effectively within the review process.

Understanding the difference between feedback and rejection helps you respond appropriately, know what to expect from each outcome, understand how to proceed based on the type of feedback received, take appropriate next steps to move your submissions forward, and work effectively within the review and feedback process.